THE PRIME MINISTER'S OFFICE
REGIONAL ADMINISTRATION AND LOCAL GOVERNMENT
LONGIDO DISTRICT MID TERM JOINT EXAMINATION

FORM ONE
036 COMPUTER SCIENCE

Time: 2:30 Hours **Tuesday, 1st September 2026 p.m.**

Instructions

1. This paper consists of sections A, B, and C with a total of ten questions.
2. Answer **ALL** questions.
3. All answers must be written in the spaces provided.
4. Write your examination number on every page in this question paper.
5. All writing must be in blue/black ink. Diagrams must be drawn in pencil and labeled in ink.
6. Cell phones and calculators are not allowed in the examination room

QUESTION NUMBER	SCORE	INITIALS OF EXAMINER
1		
2		
3		
4		
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9		
10		
TOTAL		

SECTION A (15 MARKS)

1. Choose the correct answer from the alternatives A, B, C and D. Each question carries 1 mark.

(i) Computer Science is mainly concerned with the study of:
- A. Plants and animals
- B. Computers, information and computational processes
- C. Weather and climate
- D. Buildings and construction

(ii) Which of the following is an example of computer hardware?
- A. Microsoft Word
- B. Windows
- C. Keyboard
- D. Antivirus program

(iii) The physical parts of a computer that can be seen and touched are called:
- A. Software
- B. Hardware
- C. Data
- D. Information

(iv) Which one of the following is system software?
- A. Windows
- B. Calculator
- C. Paint
- D. Microsoft Word

(v) Which component is mainly responsible for processing instructions in a computer?
- A. Monitor
- B. Keyboard
- C. CPU
- D. Speaker

(vi) Which of the following is the best way to protect a computer from dust?
- A. Pouring water on it
- B. Covering it when it is not in use
- C. Keeping food beside it
- D. Placing it on the floor

(vii) Which of the following is an example of preventive computer maintenance?
- A. Cleaning dust from the computer regularly
- B. Breaking the keyboard
- C. Removing important system files
- D. Disconnecting cables unnecessarily

(viii) A computer that suddenly switches off while being used may have a problem with:
- A. Power supply
- B. Mouse pad
- C. Wallpaper
- D. Desktop colour

(ix) Which device is mainly used to display information from a computer?
- A. Scanner
- B. Monitor

C. Keyboard
D. Microphone

(x) When troubleshooting a computer problem, the first important step is to:
A. Guess and replace all components
B. Identify and understand the problem
C. Throw away the computer
D. Delete all files

Answers

(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)	(ix)	(x)

2. Match each item in list A with the most appropriate answer in list B. Write the correct letter beside each number. Each item carries 1 mark.

LIST A	LIST B
i. Keyboard	A. Software used to protect a computer from malware
ii. CPU	B. Used for entering text and numbers
iii. Monitor	C. Processes instructions and controls computer operations
iv. Antivirus	D. Displays information to the user
v. Operating system	E. Manages computer hardware and software resources
	F. Used to produce sound

Answers

LIST A	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)
LIST B					

SECTION B (70 MARKS)

3. Amina has just joined Form One. She knows how to switch on a computer, but she does not understand what Computer Science means or why it is important in everyday life.
(a) Define the term Computer Science.

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(b) State three areas where Computer Science is useful in everyday life.

(i) …..……

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(ii) ……..……

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(iii) ……..……

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(c) Explain two ways in which learning Computer Science can help a student in school and in the future.

(i) ……

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(ii) ……

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4. A school has purchased new computers for its laboratory. The teacher explains that a computer system is more than just the physical machine because it involves several components working together.

(a) What is a computer system?

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(b) Name three major components of a computer system.

(i) ……

(ii) ……

(iii) ……

(c) Explain how two of the components you named work together to enable a computer to perform a task.

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5. During a practical lesson, Seypalm is asked to identify different computer devices. He identifies a keyboard, mouse, monitor, printer and CPU but is unsure about their functions.

(a) Define computer hardware.

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(b) State the functions of three hardware devices mentioned in the scenario.

(i) ……

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(ii) ……

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(iii) ……

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(c) Distinguish between input devices and output devices, giving one example of each.

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6. Neema wants to type a letter, browse the internet and play a video on a school computer. Her teacher tells her that she needs appropriate software to perform these activities.
   (a) What is computer software?

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   (b) Name three examples of computer software.

   (i) ….……

   (ii) ……..……..

   (iii) ……..……

   (c) Explain the difference between system software and application software, giving one example of each.

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7. A group of students is using computers in the laboratory. One student eats food near the computer, another pulls cables forcefully, and another student covers the computer after use.
   (a) State three rules for proper handling and care of computer equipment.

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   (b) Identify three unsafe practices shown in the scenario.

   (i) ….……

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   (ii) ……..……..

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   (iii) ……..……

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(c) Explain two possible effects of poor handling and care of computers.

(i) ….……

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(ii) …….……..

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8. The computers in a school laboratory have become slow and dusty. Some keyboards have accumulated dirt, and the teacher wants to keep the computers working properly for a long time.

(a) What is meant by computer system maintenance?

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(b) State three maintenance activities that can be performed on computers.

(c) Explain two benefits of carrying out regular computer maintenance.

9. During a computer lesson, a student presses the power button, but the computer does not start. The monitor is also blank. The student immediately thinks that the computer is damaged.

(a) What is meant by computer troubleshooting?

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(b) State three things the student should check before concluding that the computer is damaged.

(i) ….……

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(ii) …….……..

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(iii) …….……

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(c) Describe two general steps that should be followed when solving a computer problem.

(i) ….……

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(ii) …….……..

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SECTION C (15 MARKS)

10. Your school has recently opened a new computer laboratory. After several months, some computers are becoming slow, keyboards are dirty, cables are poorly arranged, and some computers occasionally fail to start. The head of the computer department asks you, as a Form One student, to advise other students on how to keep the laboratory computers safe and functional.

    Write an essay explaining how students can:

    - Handle and care for computer systems properly;
    - Carry out simple computer maintenance;
    - Prevent common computer problems; and
    - Troubleshoot simple computer problems when they occur.

    Give relevant examples in your explanation.